

THE PYRAMIDS

Dozens of tombs and temples dot the desert sands at Giza, but they are all overshadowed by three colossal stone pyramids. These great structures were built as tombs for pharaohs, who were the rulers of ancient Egypt. The pyramids are an astonishing feat of engineering—they were built more than 4,500 years ago, using little more than muscle power.



Riverside site

Giza is located on the lower stretch of the Nile River, which flows north into the Mediterranean Sea. The site sits at the edge of the modern Egyptian capital, Cairo.

The falcon behind Khafre's head is a symbol of Horus, a god who protected the pharaohs.



River transportation

The ancient Egyptians used the Nile River to transport materials. At the time, water was the only way to carry heavy loads over long distances. Stone was brought along the Nile from elsewhere in Egypt to adorn the tombs and temples at Giza.

Khafre forever

Pharaoh Khafre was one of the rulers of ancient Egypt's Old Kingdom. He reigned from around 2558 to 2532 BCE. Ancient Egyptian rulers sought to live on through the buildings and statues they left behind. Khafre had over 300 statues of himself made for a temple beside the pyramid.

Treasure for the afterlife

Many royal and important people were buried or entombed in smaller tombs near the three large pyramids at Giza. They were buried with precious items, such as gold and jewelry.



These bracelets were found in the tomb of Khafre's grandmother, Queen Hetepheres I.

